

THE FORUM

A mechanically-unbiased discussion platform that produces
definitive, polished, informed opinions;
giving voice to each tribe of thought on divisive issues

THE PROBLEM

As a nation we are in deep trouble:

NOT INFORMED

Many widely-held yet easily-refuted beliefs

WE HAVE NO TRUSTED SOURCES – ALL ARE TAINTED

- **Social media** is driven by *virality*, not truth
- **Mainstream media** sensationalizes for *viewership*
- **Gov agencies** have *political agendas*
- **Big business** values *profit* over truth
- **Academia** is *more liberal* than the population

→ **NO TRUSTED SOURCE** means **NO REALITY CHECK** ←

The Forum's Mission

To shape discourse using (1) informed, (2) open-minded, (3) experts, (4) from **MY** tribe, (5) speaking in **MY** voice, who dig into complex issues and separate fact from fiction.

WHAT CAN POWER THIS FORUM?

People's desire:

FOR MEANING

meaning in their lives,
meaning by providing benefit to others

TO BE HEARD

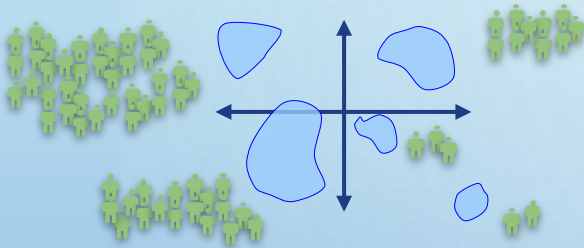
to have visibility & their voice heard

TO CONVINC

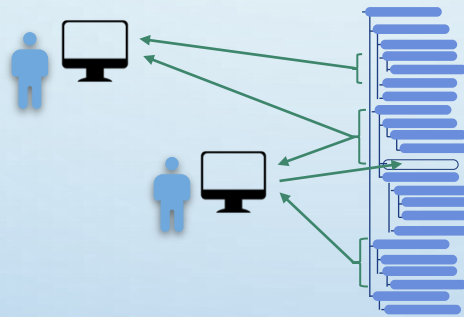
To convince / educate others
those issues they see clearly

THE SOLUTION

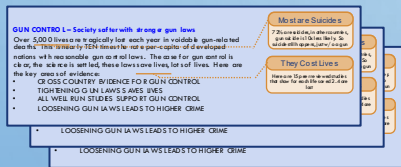
Identify & recruit representative discussion communities using surveys



Participants listen and post onto a colossal threaded discussions tree



- Like
 - Email/HackerNews Threading
 - Quora Q/A
 - Reddit subscribing
 - Wikipedia authoritative & collaborative editing
- Participants are
 - Congenial & Motivated



Output is a “Wikipedia” of the informed, critiqued opinions of each *trusted* tribe’s thinking

A trusted voice from **MY** tribe

Self-working algorithm bubbles most-supported least-biased ideas to the top



The **Facebook** algorithm rewards *virality*.
The **Forum** algorithm rewards *informed, balanced, open, expert* opinions.

100% mechanical, 100% transparent

EXAMPLE OUTPUT:

THE “GUNS AND SOCIETY” ISSUE

2022 → GUNS & SOCIETY



What gun laws & policies should we have?

ISSUE: Should citizens have greater access to guns or greater restrictions placed on access to them? The two largest positions are the pro-gun and anti-gun positions, with a distant third being an “individual rights” position.

THREE POSITIONS

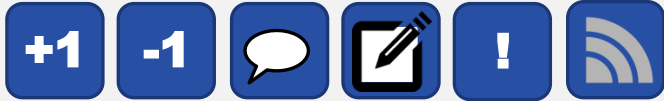
[GUN-CONTROL](#) – Society is better and safer with much stronger gun control laws

[GUN-ACCESS](#) – Gun control doesn't work; crime increases, and innocents are killed

[GUN-RIGHTS](#) – Self-defense is a basic human right as written right into our great constitution

GUN CONTROL (POSITION STATEMENT)

2022 → Guns → GUN CONTROL



Position: Society is much safer with strong gun control laws

Over 5,000 lives are tragically lost each year in avoidable gun-related deaths. This is nearly TEN times the rate per-capita of developed nations with reasonable gun control laws. The case for gun control is clear, the science is settled, these laws save lives, lots of lives. Here are the key areas of evidence:

- CROSS COUNTRY EVIDENCE FOR GUN CONTROL
- TIGHTENING GUN LAWS SAVES LIVES
- ALL WELL RUN STUDIES SUPPORT GUN CONTROL
- LOOSENING GUN LAWS LEADS TO HIGHER CRIME

Majority are Suicides ✓✓✓

72% are suicides, in other countries, gun suicide is 10x less likely. Suicide still happens, just w/o a gun

Suicides don't change this ✓✓✓

Even when we remove suicides there is still 5.5x more gun deaths than other developed countries

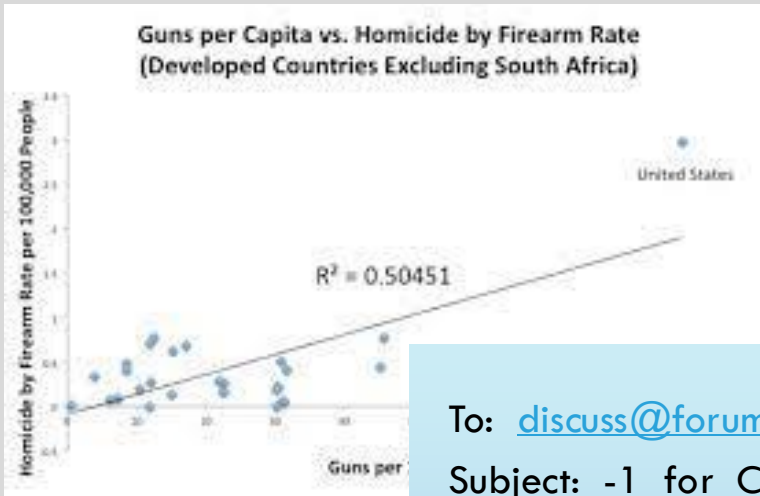
It's not about the guns! ✓...

Even non-gun homicide in the USA are many times that of other nations.
IT'S NOT ABOUT THE GUNS!

JOINING THE DISCUSSION

(A SIMPLE EXAMPLE OF SOMEONE POSTING A “-1” COMMENT)

2022 → Guns → Control → CROSS COUNTRY EVIDENCE FOR GUN CONTROL



In this 1995 study we see a very clear trend. More guns, more death.

To: discuss@forum.org

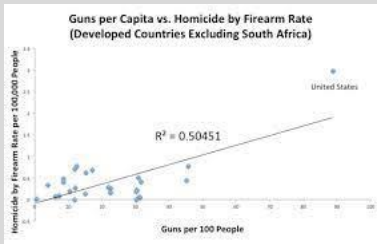
Subject: -1 for Cross Country Evidence For Gun Control

CHERRY PICKING THE DATA – An honest comparison of gun ownership (like [this](#) one) shows a NEGATIVE correlation to gun death. You are cherry picking the data. Not only have they excluded non-developed nations to skewing the data upward, but then they ALSO remove a key developed nation (South Africa) in order to get the correlation, they wanted.

JOINING THE DISCUSSION

(EXAMPLE OF SOMEONE PROPOSING AN EDIT TO A POSITION)

2022 → Guns → Control → CROSS COUNTRY EVIDENCE FOR GUN CONTROL



In this 1995 study we see a very clear trend. More guns, more death.

To: discuss@forum.org

Subject: Edit for Cross Country Evidence For Gun Control

We are getting hammered in the responses for our exclusion of South Africa. I know there are very good reasons to exclude South Africa, still I think our case is simpler and hence stronger if we simply include it. The effect is still seen, it is just not as large. I proposed replacing our figure and associated text with this:

33 As you can see in [Figure 3 which has South Africa removed because of its
34 recent apartheid history.] We see ...

[Figure 3 shows the positive correlation between gun ownership and homicide rate]



ALGORITHMICALLY DERIVED METRICS

Alignment

Percentile match to a given tribe



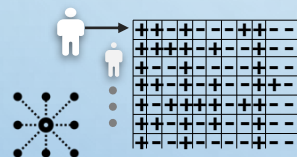
Authority

Do others in tribe respect & follow you?



Consistency

Percent match w 20 closest others



Congeniality

Other's assessment of friendliness and ability to compromise w. integrity

- Do others like discussions with you?
- When you disagree, do you propose alternatives you could agree with?



Openness

Do ever "break ranks" on factual questions when moderates are united?
After extended discussion or new info?



Accuracy

Percent

Match Experts & others with high accuracy

Others assess you as accurate

Match Experts & others with high accuracy

Opinions stand the test of time



Expertise

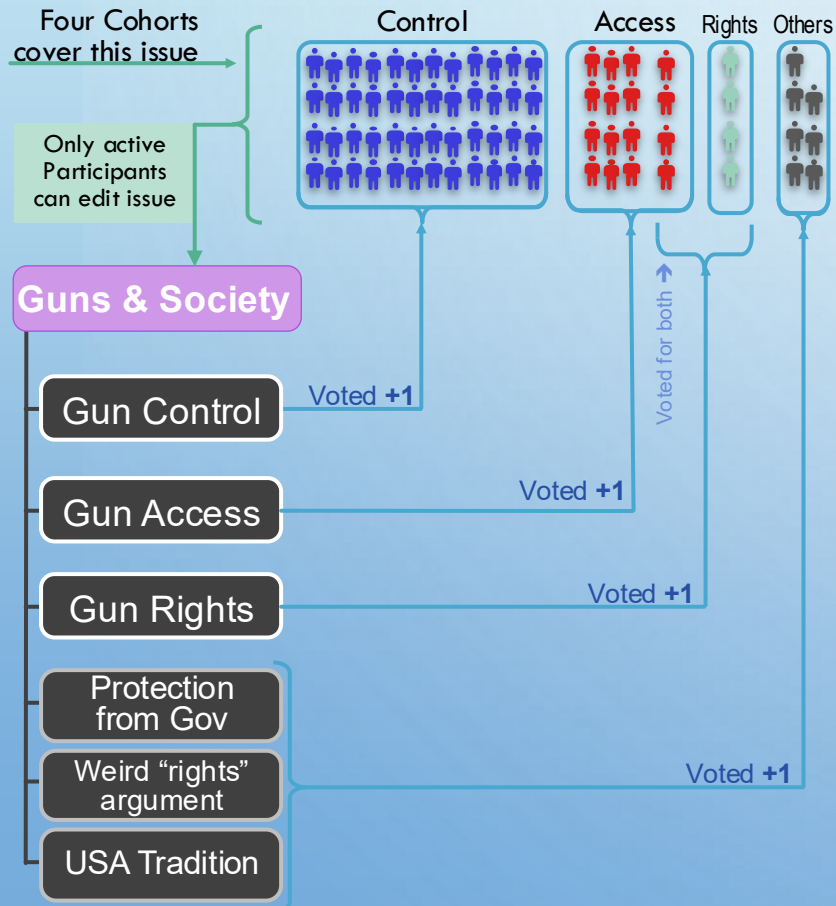
Do your opinions match experts on factual questions in their area?



FORUM ALGORITHM

Bubbles Up Best Positions

Computing the **Covering** for an Issue



Bubbles Up The **Best Version** Of A Note

Computing **support** & **balance**

WINNER: The Most
Balanced & supported

Guns & Society

Most weighted support

Gun Ownership

Most absolute support

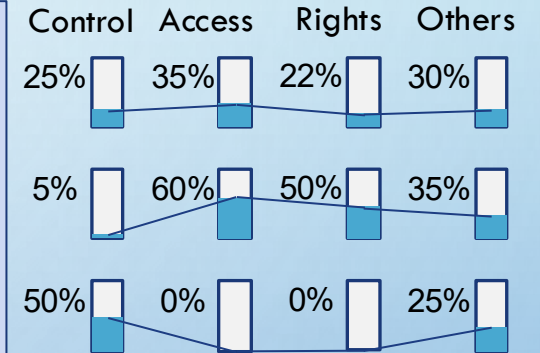
Gun Safety

Score = Support + Balance

$$1.36 = .56 + .80$$

$$0.90 = .75 + .15$$

$$0.45 = .37 + .10$$



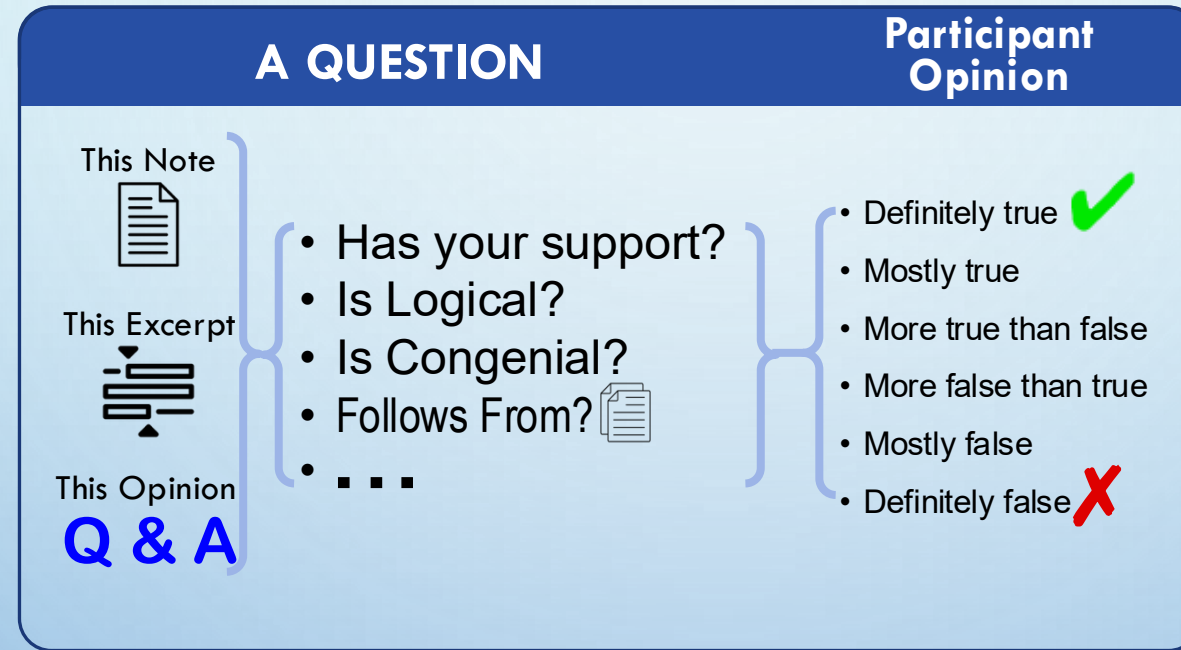
Avoids Wikipedia's edit wars!

It continuously computes support and balance over several versions and bubbles best one(s) to the top

Forum avoids tyranny of the majority

The much greater number of gun control advocates does not allow them to control the narrative.

ALGORITHMICALLY GENERATED QUESTIONS



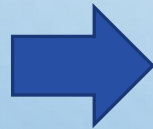
Raw data alg uses to assess people, positions, and opinions

HIGHEST VALUE OUTPUTS



Algorithm identifies participants with high:

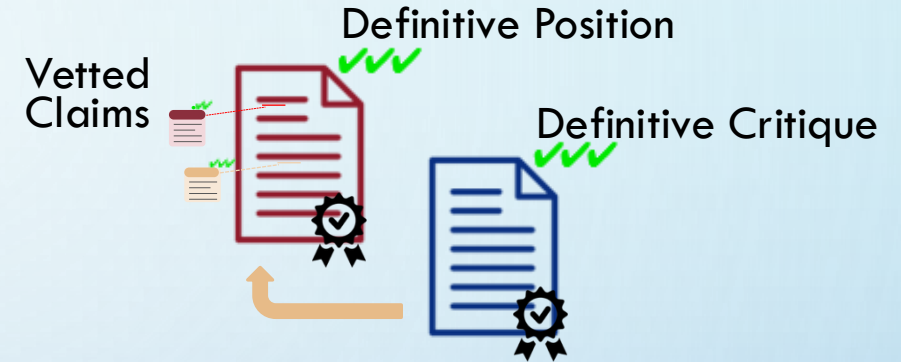
- Authority
- Consistency
- Congeniality
- Openness and
- Accuracy



Algorithm automatically selects small teams with:

- Opposing alignments
- Or High expertise and high alignment.

As needed for the output



To lead creation of *consensus*

- Issue Framings
- Position Statements
- Alignment supported conclusions

Invited participant use peer authority to gain aligned support.

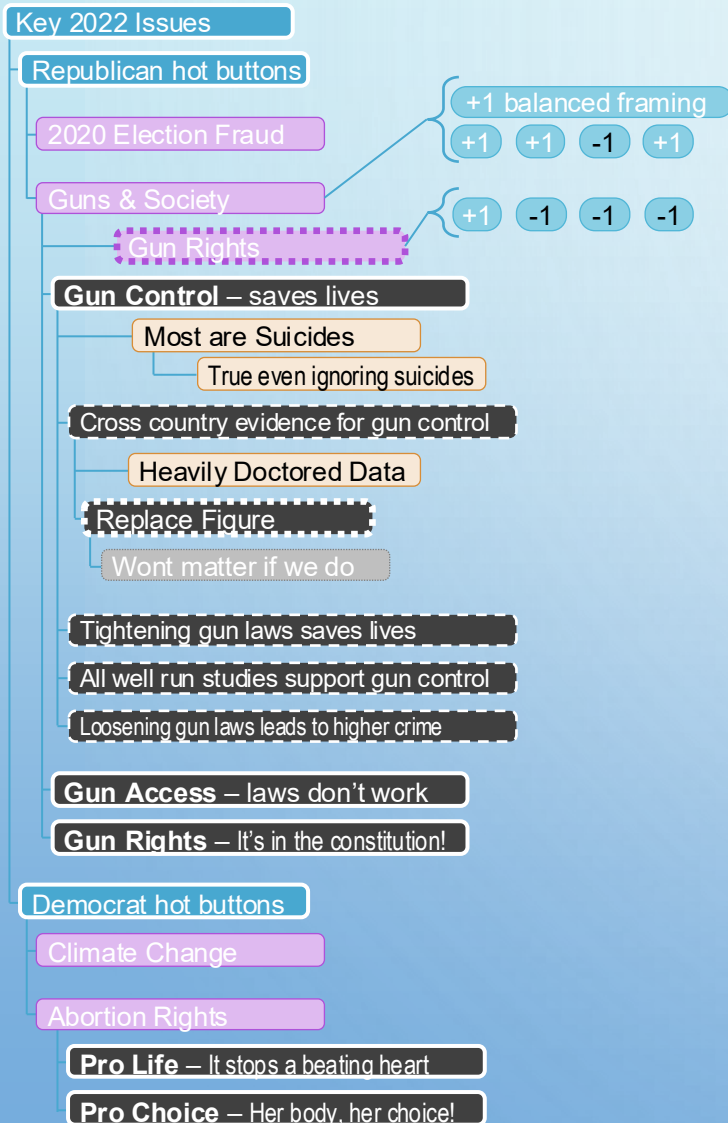
Finally, a source ***I*** can trust!

Mechanically
Unbiased &
Transparent

Vetted, Informed,
Balanced analysis
from MY tribe

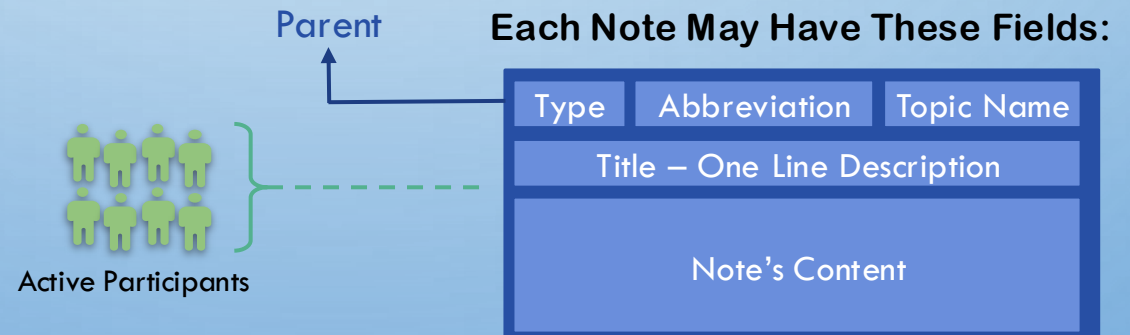
UNDERLYING DATA – A THREADED MESSAGE TREE

(USERS NEVER BROWSE THIS TREE DIRECTLY)



Types of Message Notes

Topic Area	An area of discussion
Issue	Topic upon which one adopts positions
Position	A particular stance on an issue
Critique	A challenge to parent note
Vote	A vote in support/opposition to parent
Post	A discussion in area of parent note
Sub Part	Named sub part of the parent note
Edit	Proposed edit on part or all of a note



QUESTIONS

- **MOTIVATION** – Is this mission and output motivating enough to maintain a small core of dedicated and representative participants from across the political spectrum.
- **RECRUIT** – Can participants FROM ACROSS THE SPECTRUM be recruited for this?
 - HOW – Strategies I might employ to drive the recruitment
 - Specific people? Specific groups? Specific approaches?
- **POINTERS** – What groups might care or help with this?
- **TRUST** – Will non-participants understand and trust output of the system
 - VOICE – Certain positions & critiques will be written in their voice and from their perspective
 - PUNDITS – Members from each major group can attest their voice is seen in the output
- **SPLASH** – Any sense how much the world will care about this outputs?
- **3rd PARTY EVALUATIONS** – Would other parties pay for “provably” unbiased evaluations?
- **EMAIL ONLY** – How far might I get with an email-only implementation?

FOR-PROFIT CONTENT AUDITING + A MODERATION B-CORP

Professionally-trained & paid
Full range of informed citizen perspectives
Mechanically unbiased and certified by Non-Profit

The Forum Non-Profit Org *An algorithmically-unbiased “national voice”*

- A representation of all groups accepted *by* those groups.
- Achieves visibility by weighing-in on key issues.
- Sub-groups cherry-pick findings they want to promote.

Massive TAM

- The FB’s content moderation team is larger than the entire FBI.
- TAM access hinges on reputation of the Forum.
- Is it accepted as mechanically unbiased?